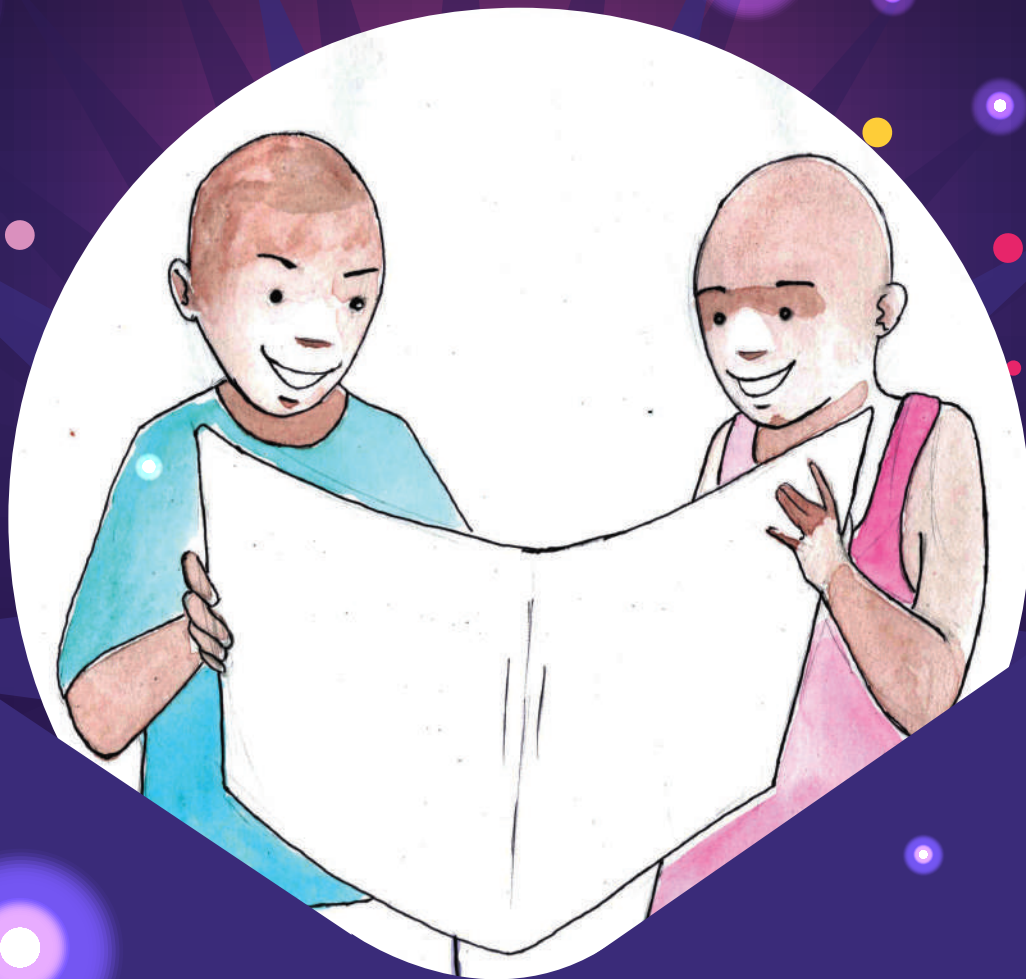




SHINING DREAMS

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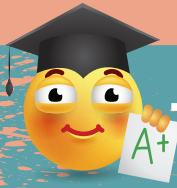
INTRODUCTION

Since the establishment in 2017 of the English Corner Workshops (ECW) at the Club Rafiki Youth Centre, the program has seen the rise of young talented boys and girls who are very enthusiastic to develop their skills at storytelling and writing. Writing their personal stories has become their passion and desire. They are committed to writing books in which they are able to express their ideas and personal experiences.

Last year ECW participants wrote "**The Rise of Hope**" and this book was very well received by people in different parts of the world. We are very happy today to present to our readers and to our sponsors our second book "**Shining Dreams**".

We appreciate the assistance and inspiration of our tutors and the support of our generous sponsors. They have all shown great confidence in us as writers.





THE BENEFIT OF EDUCATION

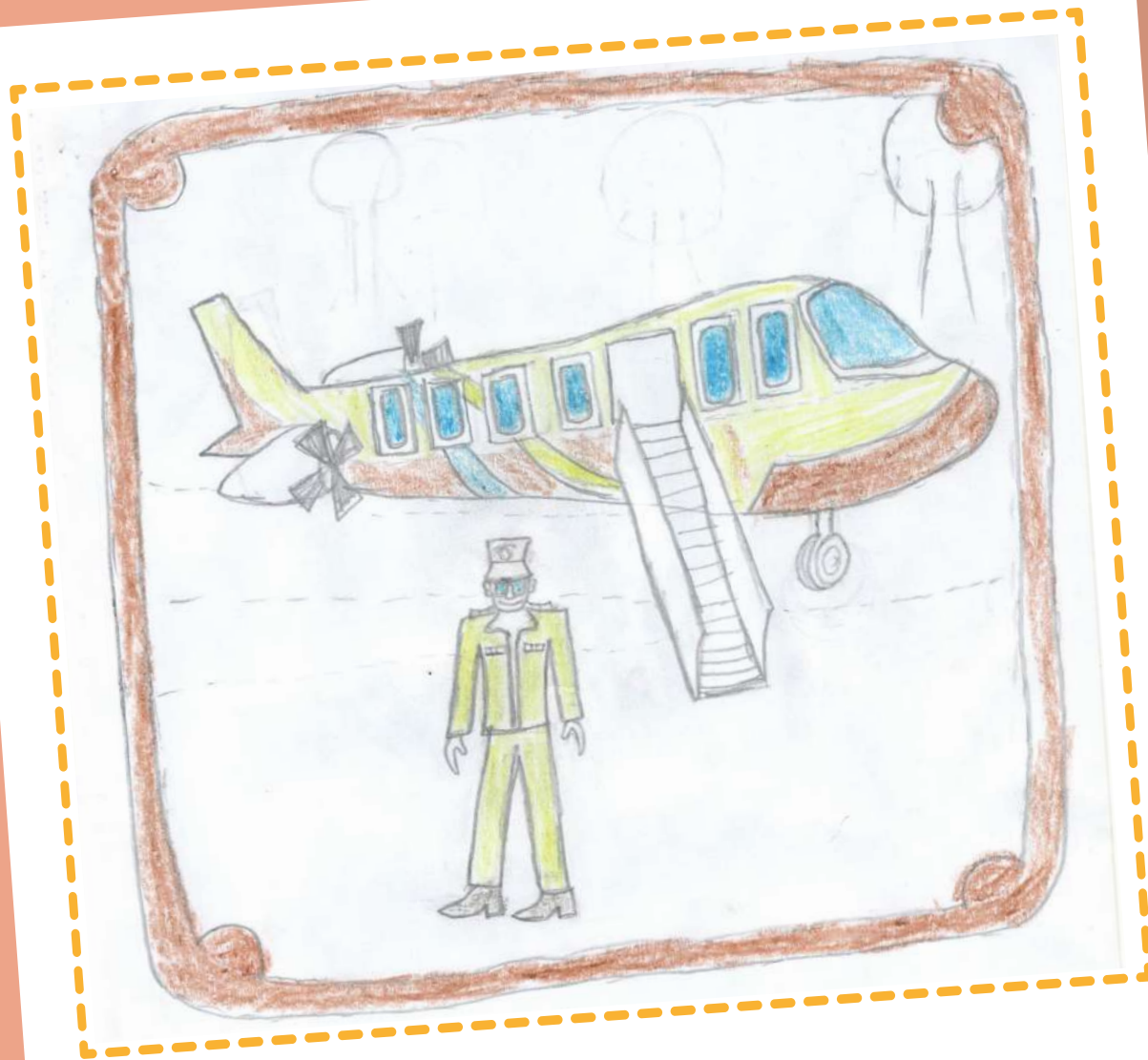
Education is important to mankind, it help us to acquire knowledge in different fields that will give us an opportunity to understand more about life and our surrounding and in mean time provide job opportunity to whoever who is educated, either is a male or a female.

Education help us to learn many things that we don't know or understand such as how to keep our body in good health, how to protect our environment and even how to interact with people of different languages and background. A person who is not educated always facing many challenges, it is difficult for him or her to have a good life, and they have to work very hard using their physcal strength to meet just their basic needs.

Educations help us also to detect different needs in our communities and implement strategies that can help develop the society. We learn more about our country and history because of education, and beside that education give us a chance to understand more about trade and commerce and many others things that are benefit to our lives.

Briefly I can say education is a key to a better future, and for that we must all value it and never deny any child a chance to education.

BY IRANKUNDA FABRICE
17 YEARS OLD.



The benefit of Education



HOLIDAY AFTER SCHOOL TERM

My name is Niyonkuru Idrissa, I live in Nyakabanda sector and I would like to talk about school holiday how important it is to me and to other school children as well. Most of us enjoy holidays because it give us an opportunity to make new friends and spent some quality time with our parent and sibling while helping with different duties at home.

During my school holidays of second term, we went to visit our Grandparents in a country side, we arrived there in afternoon our journey took us three hour drive from Kigali, my grandmother was very happy to see us but our grandfather was on the farm taking care of livestock he didn't know that we arrived but they called for him to announce that we are home, he was so excited to meet us after a long period, I was very happy because it was my first time travelling to western province and immediately I fall in love with the place, the environment was breath taking and the nature is beautiful there, the tree and view of the Lac kivu was amazing and I was surprised at the way people live and the distance that separate one house to another. That afternoon my grandpa took me around to show me the pasture and the farm, I was so blessed because I learned lot of things about farming and village life that day, in evening after having diner in family, our Grandfather told us ancient stories then we went to bed.

We spent two weeks there before returning to Kigali because our holiday was finished but during that period I learned things that I couldn't learn in city such as, making fire without using match stick, hissing like a bird, singing traditional song and ancient poem and making pots with clay. I'm so glad with that visit and looking forward to continue visiting country side often.

BY NIYONKURU IDRISSA
15 YEARS OLD



Holiday after school term

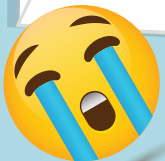
FROM HARDSHIP TO A BETTER LIFE

My name is Twizerimana Elysee, I lost my father when I was still very young then my mother raised me alone. In 2017 my mother also passed away and at that time we were living in Northern Province a place called Rubavu. Life became very hard for me, I couldn't afford to provide for my needs and it was so bad and unbearable for 15 years old boy whom I was. Fortunately one day I met this woman who used to know my mother and she decided to take me to go live with her and her two children in her house and she become like a mother to me, I didn't attend school at that time because no one could have provide for me school fees and materials.

In November 2018 we move to come live in Kigali city a place called Nyamirambo, things start to ameliorate and going well, I really enjoy living here in the city, people are friendly and most of children are attending school and there is many opportunity for a young boy my age here. Then I was introduced to English corner workshop at Club Rafiki by a friend I met who was attending English class there, I started attending class in English corner and this is the biggest achievement in my life because I'm really enjoying class and my English is improving very well.

Finally I would like to thanks my teachers and class mate for being so kind to me and helping me pursuing my dreams by giving me this opportunity to write my personal story.

BY TWIZERIMANA ELYSEE
17 YEARS OLD





Never give up your dream because
there is still hope when there is life



OUR SOCIAL LIFE AT HOME

My name is Irakoze Raissa and I'm nine years old. At home we are seven, my father and my mother and five of us, three girls and two boys. During holidays when we wake up in a morning, we clean our room and made our bed before we do anything else, after that we brush our teeth and wash our body then we can have breakfast which is mostly porridge and bread or doughnut. Then my father left to work and my mother went to the market where she sell fruit and vegetable and the rest of us stay at home helping with domestics work such as, cleaning the house, go fetch water, wash the dishes and others household duties.

At lunch time, our mother come home to prepare food for the house while me and my sibling are playing with our friend in the yard, I always play with my sisters because our brothers like to go play with their friends football and others sport for boys but it never bother us because we also have fun with our friends and most of them we have same age and we grown up together.

Our social life at home it always fun and special because everyone has it own space to enjoy freedom and it is very important to everyone in our family because we does help each other in so many way and I would like to encourage others children to always work together with siblings and parent by sharing responsibility when it come to household duties.

By **IRAKOZE RAISSA**
9 YEARS OLD



Our social life at home



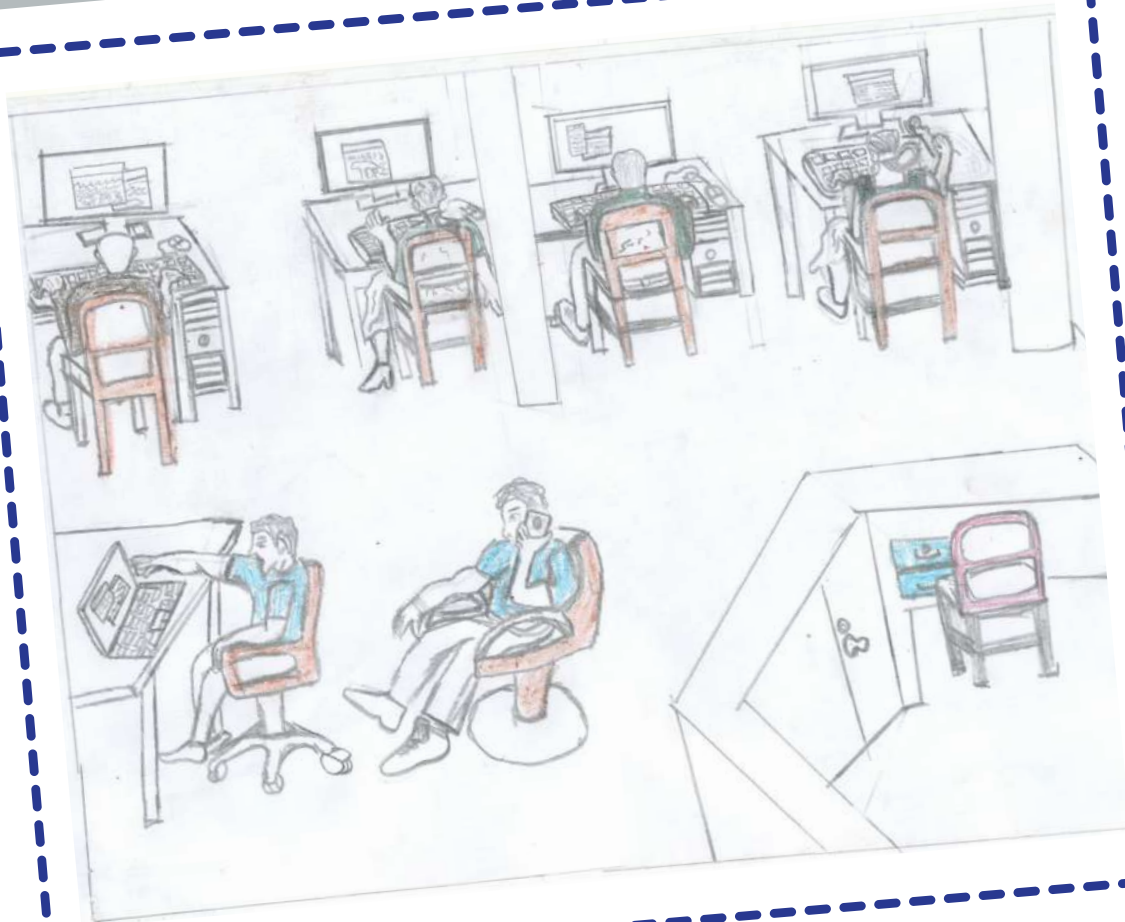
MIRACLE OF TECHNOLOGY

When you look back centuries ago, we were still living in a shadow of using letters , oral messenger, sign languages, homing birds and others primitives way of communicating . To pass a message from one person to another depended on the distance. It could have taken days or months even years and beside that the way of transportation and infrastructure was still at low level compare to nowadays.

In the generation of 21 century, technology has widen at a speed rate, which means speed of internet, Telecommunication has improved even in the remote area, transport and infrastructure has developed to the point mankind become aware of things and discovery he couldn't understand in the past, travelling between one place to another became much easier and faster due to availability of Train, Car, Airplane, Ships and even space travelling become available to public to those who can afford. even communication by phone and others means become reality to majority of people .

We have seen how people have developed themselves and acquired news skills and experiences in different fields because of expansion of technology either in Medicine, aeronautics, architectural, art and science etc. We also did witnessed millions and millions who due to technology have learned foreign languages and culture and understand more about their advance in technology

By UMUBYEYI JOYEUSE
16 YEARS OLD



Miracle of Technology



THE BEAUTY OF SPEAKING ENGLISH

English is one of the most spoken language in the world, it dominate in all aspect of our life from education, medicine, trade and commerce, art and entertainment and many others field. And thus give English language a great influence and top priority more than others languages.

In fact I was one of the person who used to avoid speaking English in public, to me English was a very strange language although I needed it at school even in my social life, I couldn't come to term with it, I was ashamed and afraid to speak my mind freely in English until I started to fail my exams at school and it was painful to my parent who do everything so that I can have an education.

Later on that year during holiday I started to make much effort to improve my English, it wasn't easy, I had to sacrifice and work very hard In order to reach my goal, I understand that the only way is to feel free and confident when talking to the audience, fortunately after months of practice in storytelling and writing, debate and others technique I started to build confidence in English I also succeed well my exams at school and I realized that nothing is impossible.

Now I'm confident and I don't fear to speak in public because I believe practice make perfect, I'm also happy for the opportunity to write this small personal story about the beauty of speaking English.

By **GIHOZO ZAWADI**
15 YEARS OLD



The beauty of speaking English



BELOVED RWANDA

You may guess why I say my Beloved Rwanda, it is because I was born in Rwanda, and my elders always told me that there is no place like home, it was hard to me to understand those words but as i started growing up, I became aware of the meaning and realized that a true patriot must love his country and prepare to sacrifice anything for it.

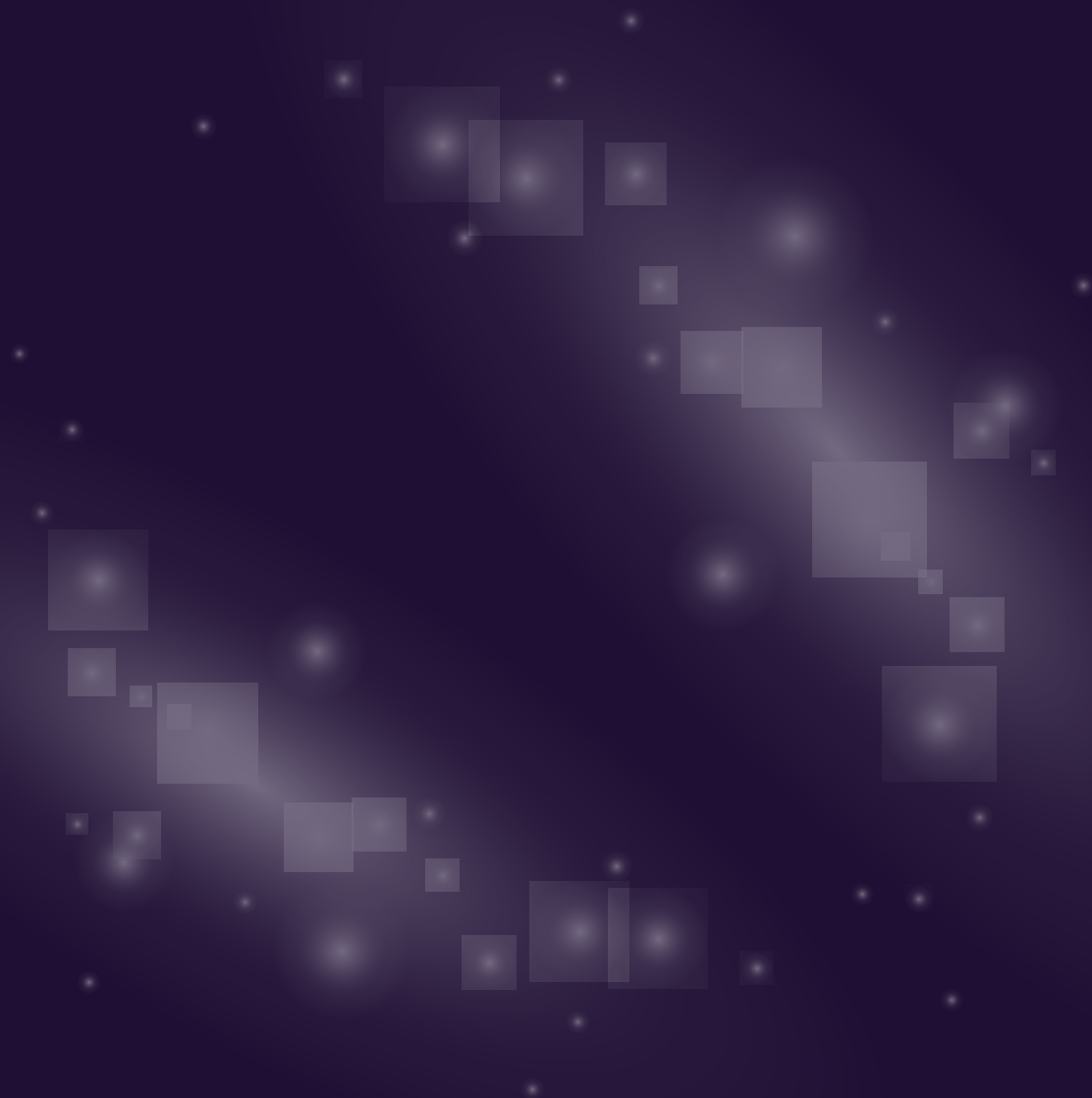
Firstly Rwanda is developing every single days no matter the tragedy it did face in 1994, Rwanda continue to organized itself by promoting the spirit of unity among it citizen in term of preventing those bad ideology of genocide and division between tribes. To keep Rwandan citizens together and in harmony it is a duty of each and every one of us. Secondly Rwanda is one of African countries that attract many tourist from around the world and that is because of good governance from our leader, it security and stability and due to our beautiful environment that has everything to offer to visitors, from different animals species in our parks and mountain to a land mark with thousand and thousand hills and also our tropical Climate which is favored by many tourist as well.

Finally I would appeal to all Rwandan to work together hand in hand to build our beloved country, as an unique country we share the same country, same culture and same language as well so let us share together the dream of build and develop our beloved country.

By IRANKUNDA Abdoul Djalil
17 YEARS OLD



Beloved Rwanda



SHINING DREAMS
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